RAHUL PRANASSERI

Level Designer / Game Designer · Unreal Engine 5 & Blueprints

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PROFILE

Level and game designer who designs levels, combat encounters and gameplay systems, then builds them myself in Unreal Engine 5, from paper map and greybox through to final set dressing and lighting. I have 13 months of studio experience as a Level Designer at O-Sens Studio and more than three years of freelance Unreal Engine work for international clients, including a released game. I graduated in September 2026 with an MSc in Computer Games Design (Merit) from Staffordshire University. I work in Blueprints for gameplay, AI behaviour trees and level streaming, iterate on my levels through playtesting, and keep scenes running well through performance optimisation.

EXPERIENCE

Level Designer / Unreal Engine Game Developer — O-Sens Studio Aug 2024 – Sep 2025

Independent start-up studio making action games in Unreal Engine 5

- Designed and built UE5 levels for the studio's in-development games, focused on gameplay flow, pacing and player immersion.
- Delivered a boss fight arena, hidden cave and temple courtyard environments from blockout to final, shaping each space around its encounter while matching the game's art style.
- Built dynamic environment loading (Data Layers / level streaming) and optimised large open-world scenes for performance.
- Implemented interactive mechanics in Blueprints to support player progression, and prototyped and refined features with a small team.
- Created environments with Quixel Megascans, asset packs and kitbashing.

Freelance Game Developer (Level Design, Environment Art, Combat & AI) — Self-employed Apr 2023 – Present

- **The Boys: Ascent** (released fan game, open-world action): developed Homelander's gameplay systems in Blueprints, optimised the City Sample map and contributed to level design.
- **Nightclub Fight Arena** (studio client): designed a close-quarters combat arena from blockout to final, handling layout, set dressing, lighting and optimisation while staying readable for gameplay.
- **Unreal short film** (Canadian client): built three large cinematic levels, including a European riverside town, set dressed and composed for camera.
- **Urban Trap Safehouse**: interactive urban environment for a project in development.
- Worked remotely with clients worldwide to their briefs and deadlines, building performance-friendly environments for PC and multiplayer.

Paid Research Participant — Meta Aug 2025

- Built a working game prototype in Roblox Studio with AI tools within a two-hour research task, compared it with Unreal Engine for rapid prototyping, and gave structured feedback on AI-assisted game development workflows.

SELECTED PROJECTS

The Broken Camp — MSc Final Project (solo) 2026

Single-player military third-person shooter · Game Designer, Level Designer, Gameplay Scripting · UE5.7

- Designed a mission that moves from stealth infiltration to combat to helicopter extraction, from paper map through greybox to a fully set-dressed level.
- Built the gameplay, mission and enemy AI systems in Blueprints; tuned patrol routes, enemy placement, searchlights and sniper towers to control stealth difficulty and combat pacing.
- Iterated on every encounter through structured playtesting and created in-game cinematics with Sequencer. Wrote a full design document.

Knight Fight — University team project Mar – Aug 2026

Local multiplayer physics party brawler · Level Designer & Gameplay Scripting · UE5

- Designed the Victorian mansion arena from blockout to final layout, and built the ragdoll system, traps (flame, spike, oil) and health pickups in Blueprints.
- Iterated on the shared camera, trap placement and pickup locations through testing so four-player matches stayed readable without losing their chaotic feel. Also handled lighting and set dressing alongside artists and programmers.

Hospital Escape — Solo project, in development 2026

Online co-op physics comedy game for up to 4 players · Solo developer · UE5.7, Blueprints

Gauntlet Mania · Echoes Beyond the Hill — University projects (playable)

Arena combat prototype with directional combat, cinematic finishers, dynamic camera and layered feedback · 2D platformer · UE5, Blueprints

Forgotten Temple — KitBash3D *Secrets of the Luminara* challenge 2024

Cinematic environment blending the Luminara kit with Quixel Megascans, from blockout to final

SKILLS

Design	Level design, greyboxing / blockouts, mission and encounter design, combat design, gameplay and AI design, player guidance and pacing, environmental storytelling, playtesting and iteration, design documentation
Unreal Engine 5	Blueprints, AI Behavior Trees, Sequencer, Niagara VFX, Data Layers and level streaming, lighting, performance optimisation, Fab / Quixel Megascans / KitBash3D
Tools	Blender (basic modelling), Roblox Studio, Perforce, Git and GitHub
Languages	English, Hindi, Malayalam, Tamil

EDUCATION

MSc Computer Games Design (Merit) — Staffordshire University, UK 2025 – Sep 2026

Modules: Advanced Game Design and Research, Advanced Prototyping, Gameplay System Design, Game Feel and Polish, Game Master Project, Project Management and Research Methods, Professional Practice and Entrepreneurship

B.Tech Computer Science with Big Data Visualization — SRM IST Ramapuram, Chennai 2020 – 2024

Graduated with 8.5 CGPA

INTERESTS

Game development, playing games, travelling, swimming, football, music, films.